BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #43 · DISABILITY AND IMPAIRMENT

“If I can't be independent, I have no dignity.”

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Where it often comes from

Needing help with dressing, bathing, eating, or finances can feel humiliating. A culture that prizes independence can make dependence seem shameful.

What Scripture teaches

Dignity comes from God: “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor” (Psalm 8:5). Jesus washed His disciples’ feet and told them to serve one another. “The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor.” “Carry one another’s burdens.” Dignity is a gift of creation and redemption, not of independence. Receiving care graciously honors both giver and receiver.

> *“You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor”* (Psalm 8:5).

Also see

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor. And our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty, whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God has composed the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it” (1 Corinthians 12:22–24).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you” (Isaiah 46:4).

Common self-statements

- I am humiliated by needing help.
- I have lost my dignity.
- Being cared for makes me small.
- I am a child again.
- I hate being dependent.
- I am diminished.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either independent or undignified.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will lose all respect.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding that I have no dignity.
- Labeling: Calling myself undignified.

Challenging questions

- What does dignity mean to me, and where did I learn it?
- How do I treat others who need help?
- How does God see people who need care?
- What choices do I still make for myself?
- How can I direct my care with respect?
- What can I offer those who help me?

Truth summary

> My dignity comes from God, who crowned me with glory and honor. Needing help does not remove it. I can direct my care, accept help graciously, and give thanks.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Humility
- Pride
- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Weakness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I can't be independent, I have no dignity"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I can't be independent, I have no dignity." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does dignity mean to me, and where did I learn it?
- ☐ How do I treat others who need help?
- ☐ How does God see people who need care?
- ☐ What choices do I still make for myself?
- ☐ How can I direct my care with respect?
- ☐ What can I offer those who help me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God crowned me with glory and honor.
- ☐ Weaker parts are given greater honor.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ I can direct my care.
- ☐ Receiving is a gift.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 8:5
  "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22–24
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor. And our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty, whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God has composed the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Dignity intact: Each week, note one choice you made about your own care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 8:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God crowned me with glory and honor.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Humility" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your choices. Write what you can decide.
- [ ] Speak up. Tell caregivers how you prefer help.
- [ ] Say thanks. Let helpers know it matters.
- [ ] Read Psalm 8. Remember your crown.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I can't be independent, I have no dignity": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Dignity intact
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I can't be independent, I have no dignity.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I struggle with needing help. Remind me that You crowned me with glory and honor, and help me receive care with grace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.